EMILY CHELSEA JEWELRY · OPERATIONS REFERENCE

How the website works: every rule in one place

Every automated sync, filter, and business rule configured on emilychelseajewelry.com — written for anyone managing the store, with pointers to where each rule can be changed in WordPress admin.

Last updated 2026-08-28 · source of truth: theme repo, `docs/WEBSITE-RULES.md`

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01 Automated syncs & scheduled jobs

Meta (Facebook / Instagram) product feed — every hour

- The site rebuilds a product data feed **every hour**, automatically. Meta Commerce Manager pulls it from `/wp-content/uploads/meta-feed.csv`.
- **Included:** published products in the categories `bracelets`, `pins`, `earrings`, `necklaces`, `other-rings`. Everything else — engagement rings, center stones — is **not** in the feed.
- Products with variations are exported one row per variation (its own price, stock status, and image), grouped under the parent product.
- Fixed values: brand “Emily Chelsea Jewelry”, condition “new”, prices in USD. Google product categories are mapped from the WooCommerce category (e.g. necklaces →

Apparel & Accessories › Jewelry › Necklaces).

> MANUAL REFRESH
>
> A logged-in administrator can force an immediate rebuild by adding `?regen_meta_feed=1` to any page URL. The page responds with the feed URL when done.

Custom-field definitions (ACF sync)

All custom field structures (product config, theme options, block fields) live as JSON files inside the theme and are deployed like code. After a deploy, WordPress shows a "Sync available" notice under **Custom Fields → Field Groups** — syncing applies the new definitions to the database.

Code deployment (developer-side)

Theme code is deployed over SFTP by a script that uploads only the files changed in git (and removes remotely what was deleted), with a dry-run mode and an explicit-file mode. A companion script pulls the live theme back down to keep local and production in sync. Build artifacts and the deploy tooling itself are never uploaded.

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02 Product filters (FacetWP)

What a filter *contains* is managed in Settings → FacetWP. *Which filters appear on which page* is managed in Theme Options → Products.

Display rules

- Every filter shows its **full option list** — the "show more / show less" truncation is switched off for all ~20 facets (Style, Stones, Clarity, Color, Metal Type, Size, Shape, Origin, Texture, Carat Size, Side Stones, Jewelry Type, and more), each with its own custom heading.
- The stock filter's raw "instock" value is relabeled **"In Stock and Ready to Ship."**
- The results counter reads simply **"{N} results"** instead of "Showing X–Y of Z."

Indexing rules — what the filters can "see"

- **Available in Fairmined Gold:** only values containing `fairmined-gold` are indexed; everything else is excluded from that filter.
- **Band Width** values are treated as numbers, so widths sort 0.9 → 1.5 → 10 instead of alphabetically.
- FacetWP is prevented from taking over the blog home page.

Which filter bar appears where

- **Theme Options → Products → Default Filter** — the standard filter set on shop and category pages.
- **Custom Filter** — per-category, per-page, or per-URL overrides with their own filter sets.
- Blog search/filters and the search-page sort live under the **Blog** and **Search** tabs.

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03 Build-A-Ring

A three-step wizard for assembling a custom ring (setting + stone). There are two entry flows, each with its own landing page (set in **Theme Options → Build Ring**): *Setting → Stone → Confirm* or *Stone → Setting → Confirm*. The order locks once the customer starts.

> ELIGIBILITY — THE RULE PEOPLE TRIP ON
>
> **Settings (rings):** a ring appears in the wizard only if it has the `build-a-ring` product *tag* — being in the "rings" category is not enough. This is deliberate: new rings never appear in the wizard by accident.
>
> **Center stones:** anything in the `center-stones` product *category* appears automatically.

How it behaves

- The in-progress design (the "tray") is mirrored into the cart immediately, so pricing and stock are always live.
- Customers can build **several designs in one session**; each saved design keeps its own cart lines, even when the products are identical.

- Editing a saved design pulls it back into the tray. If another design is mid-build, the customer is warned first — a complete one is auto-saved, an incomplete one discarded. Cancelling an edit leaves the cart untouched.
- **Default stone:** each buildable ring can name its own default stone (field on the product); otherwise the site-wide default from Theme Options applies.
- **Pre-checkout guard:** designs missing a ring or a stone are removed (with their cart lines) before checkout — a half-finished design can never become an order.

> DO NOT CHANGE
>
> The build-ring page is excluded from WP Rocket page caching, and its JavaScript is excluded from minify / combine / delay. Removing those exclusions breaks the drag-and-drop wizard.

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04 Product & catalog rules

What shows in shop & category listings

- **Out-of-stock products are hidden** from listings automatically.
- Products flagged *Is Special Product* or *Hide product from catalog listing* are excluded.
- Terms chosen in **Theme Options → Products → Exclude Terms from Shop Page** are excluded.
- Layout: 4 products per row, 24 per page; no “Add to cart” buttons in the grid; related products capped at 4.
- Site search returns both blog posts **and** products.

Per-product switches (Product Config fields on the product edit screen)

FIELD	EFFECT
Center Stone = *Include*	“Center Stones INCLUDED” badge in listings
Center Stone = *Not Include*	Requires a center stone in the cart to check out (§05); shows “ADD A CENTER STONE” prompt
Is Special Product	Replaces the add-to-cart form with custom CTA buttons
Hide Quantity	Hides the quantity selector
Hide Product Service	Hides the services / benefits block
CTAs	Attaches reusable Product CTA blocks below the summary (the standard WooCommerce tabs are removed site-wide)
Gallery / Video Gallery	Custom image and video gallery section
Hover Feature Image	Second image shown on hover in the product grid

The badge icon and wording (“… INCLUDED”, “ADD A CENTER STONE”) are editable on the stone category's term edit screen.

Stock & availability wording

- **“On backorder” is renamed “Made to Order”** everywhere — intentional. Backorder is a normal, sellable state, and variations are never hidden for being out of stock.
- Metal options gain a **“(Ready to Ship)”** suffix when that metal has in-stock variations; the size dropdown repopulates per selected metal, in-stock sizes first.
- Variation dropdowns read “Choose your {Attribute}.”
- **Out-of-stock simple products** hide the cart form and show an “Inquire” button — they cannot be purchased from the front end.
- The quantity box disappears when only one quantity is purchasable.

05 Cart & checkout rules

> STONE-REQUIRED RULE
>
> If any cart item is marked *Center Stone = Not Included*, the cart must also contain a product from the center-stone category — otherwise the checkout / payment button is blocked.

- **Pick up in store:** a checkout checkbox, saved on the order and shown to staff on the admin order screen.
- The header cart counter updates live without a page reload.
- Breadcrumbs on product and category pages point “home” to the **Shop page**, not the site front page.
- The WooCommerce Product Dependencies plugin is also honored for products tied to other products or categories.

06 Site-wide settings (Theme Options)

- **Store notice banner** — on/off toggle, message, background and text colors.
- **Header / Footer style presets** — the “Header” and “Footer” entries in wp-admin are *style presets* (colors, logo, backgrounds, social icons), not content. Each page or product can pick its own preset; the site-wide defaults live in Theme Options. Products normally inherit the Shop page's preset unless “Is Independence Header Config” is ticked on the product.
- **Products tab** — stone/ring categories, default stone, filter bars (§02), category purchase dependencies, product service icons (shown per category), inquiry form, “Book an appointment” link.
- **Blog / Search / 404 tabs** — search shortcode, blog filters, designated search and 404 pages.
- **Build Ring tab** — the two wizard entry pages (§03).

07 Content & appearance rules

- Blog excerpts are capped at **15 words** site-wide.
- Empty paragraphs typed in the editor are deliberately **preserved** as spacing (WordPress normally strips them).
- Hero banners are configurable per page, post, product, and category, with taller defaults on general pages than on shop or account pages.
- Custom editor blocks: Content With Image (1 & 2), Container, Products, Products Special, Posts, and **Build Ring Selection** — the embeddable drag-and-drop ring picker.

08 Analytics & caching

- **Microsoft Clarity** analytics loads on every page.
- **WP Rocket** caches the whole site *except* the Build-A-Ring flow (§03).

09 One-off admin utilities

Maintenance scripts in the theme's `tools/` folder. Apart from the Meta feed generator, these are not part of normal site behavior:

SCRIPT	WHAT IT DOES
`generate-datafeed.php`	The hourly Meta feed (§01) — **active in production**
`remove-duplicate.php`	Deletes duplicate variations (same attribute combination)
`remove-products.php`	Deletes a hardcoded list of products by ID / SKU
`update-taxable.php`	CSV-driven image alt-text / taxable updater (mostly disabled)

These act immediately when triggered — use only with a fresh backup.

10 Quick answers

Q: Why doesn't my new ring show in Build-A-Ring?

It needs the `build-a-ring` product tag. The “rings” category alone is not enough — see §03.

Q: Why is a product missing from the shop page?

It's out of stock, flagged Special / Hidden, or in an excluded term — see §04.

Q: Why can't a customer check out?

A “Not Included” center-stone product is in the cart without a stone (§05), or an incomplete build-ring design was cleared before checkout (§03).

Q: Why isn't product X in the Meta feed?

The feed only covers bracelets, pins, earrings, necklaces, and other-rings — see §01.

Q: Where do I edit the filters?

Facet contents: Settings → FacetWP. Which filters appear on which page: Theme Options → Products — see §02.

Companion documents in the theme repo: `docs/WEBSITE-RULES.md` (this document, in Markdown), `docs/LOGIC.md` (developer-level code notes), `CLAUDE.md` (theme structure & conventions).